

RetailzPOS / Moolah Points — Daily Trending Topics Brief

October 10, 2026

Trending now — 4 topics with a genuine brand angle

#	Trend	Source	Brand-twist content idea
1	Today is elimination Saturday in the MLB playoffs — ALDS Game 5s (if necessary) play today, with the NLCS starting tomorrow and the ALCS Monday. Win-or-go-home games are the highest-intensity viewing of the postseason so far.	ESPN — MLB Playoffs 2026: Full Schedule From Wild-Card Round to World Series	Instagram/TikTok, quick game-day prep post. “Elimination Saturday means the line moves faster than extra innings. Fast movers up front, cooler fully faced, and the register that doesn’t slow down when the game does.” Practical, light, no overconsumption framing — about checkout speed and shelf prep, not drink quantity.

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2	Swipe fees hit a record \$198.25B in 2025, and the political fight over them is intensifying — Illinois’s first-in-the-nation Interchange Fee Prohibition Act just survived a federal court challenge (though a data-usage provision was blocked), and President Trump has now said he supports lowering swipe fees nationally.	PYMNTS — Illinois Swipe Fee Law Upheld by Federal Court, CardRates — Trump Reignites the Battle Over Credit Card Swipe Fees	LinkedIn, sharper-question post. “Swipe fees hit a record \$198B+ nationally in 2025, and the political fight over them just got a real court ruling behind it in Illinois. Whatever happens legislatively next, the question worth asking your POS vendor hasn’t changed: can you show me, line by line, exactly where that fee goes on every transaction — not just a number buried in a monthly statement?” No product claim, same pattern as recent posts.
3	Hemp THC beverages are one of the fastest-growing categories in retail — and facing a near-term regulatory cliff. Volume grew 133% in 2025 to 1.6M+ case equivalents, mainstream retail sales hit \$239M (up 135% YoY), low-dose (6–10mg) drinks have overtaken higher-dose ones, and Target is expanding the category into more states — all while a federal ban on intoxicating hemp products remains scheduled for November 2026, with its fate still unsettled in Congress.	Shanken News Daily — Hemp THC Drinks Reached 1.6 Million Cases on Triple-Digit Growth in 2025	Instagram/LinkedIn carousel for liquor and convenience retailers carrying hemp beverages. Factual, not promotional: “This category grew 133% last year — and is also the one most exposed to the hemp ban deadline we flagged on Oct 7. If it’s on your shelf, this is a near-term merchandising decision to make deliberately, not one to get caught flat-footed on in November.” Ties directly to the ongoing hemp-ban story already covered this month, with real growth data attached.

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4	Dollar General is rolling same-day delivery out to ~20,000 stores across 48 states this fall , via a new Instacart partnership — pilot live now at ~7,000 stores in six states, with delivery in as little as one hour and no markup on in-store prices.	Retail Tech Innovation Hub — Dollar General and Instacart On-Demand Delivery Partnership	LinkedIn, industry-shift post. “When a 20,000-store dollar chain rolls out no-markup, one-hour delivery nationwide, that’s the market saying delivery isn’t a differentiator for convenience retail anymore — it’s the baseline a customer expects. Worth a real conversation about where your own store stands on that, not just a someday item.” No pricing claims, framed as industry context, not a product pitch.

Skipped, no genuine angle today: this week’s TikTok/Instagram trend roundups all pointed to stale material (a May audio trend, a July comedic sound, August movie tie-ins) — nothing confirmed current enough to use responsibly, and Aramark’s 9-9-9 postseason beer-and-hot-dog ballpark promo, which was deliberately left out since any adaptation of a literal “nine beers” bundle risks reading as encouraging overconsumption.

Compliance check: none of the above imply pricing, encourage overconsumption, or use underage-adjacent framing — #2 and #4 are vendor-question/industry-shift framing with no product claims, #3 is factual category data paired with a compliance deadline, #1 is checkout-speed and shelf-prep content with no drink-quantity framing.